SIXFOLD LLC · INTERNAL — CREW & OFFICE

Water Restrictions 2026

What the crew needs to know before promising anything about a lawn. Organised by the towns we actually work, not by which agency wrote the rule. Bold lines are for the door. Sources are for the office.

Researched **2026-09-30** Base **Monument, CO** Draft 1 — **not customer-facing**

⚑ THIS DOCUMENT GOES STALE

Drought stages move without warning. Denver Water went from normal summer rules to a total lawn-watering ban in about five weeks. **Nothing here should be quoted to a customer as current without checking the provider's own page that week.** Every provider is linked at the foot of this page.

THE ONE THING THAT SHAPES EVERYTHING ELSE

Aeration needs a watered lawn. Overseeding needs far more.

Corrected 4 Oct 2026. This first said aeration does not need water. That was wrong. Colorado State University Extension: water thoroughly the day before so deep plugs can be pulled, water soon after, keep watering regularly so the holes heal, and **do not core-aerate a lawn that is totally brown or dormant from water restrictions.**

On a green lawn, aeration still works under every provider's rules in our territory: two or three allowed days a week covers the watering before and after. What to sell where the lawn is dormant, including many household-use-only wells, is Brandon's call.

Overseeding is the exposed half. Seed needs light, frequent watering to germinate — more often than most providers now allow by sprinkler. **A customer allowed to water two or three days a week is unlikely to get a good take from an overseed**, and we do not water and do not guarantee germination.

So the risk is not legal. It is this: **we take money for seed that does not come up, and the customer blames us.** Everything below is about not walking into that.

Who governs which town

These are the providers for the towns on our walk lists. **Find out which one the property is on before promising anything about watering** — Monument alone has four.

TOWN / AREA	PROVIDER	WHERE IT STOOD 2026-09-30
Colorado Springs	Colorado Springs Utilities	**3 days a week**, your choice of days. Before 10am / after 6pm **May 1 – Oct 15**. Fines from **$100**. Entered "Water Shortage Preparation" 18 March — a preliminary stage that **kept the normal rules** rather than adding to them.
Woodland Park	City of Woodland Park	⚑ **Level 2 — two days a week**, assigned by address. No watering noon–6pm May–Sept. **The strictest in our territory.**
Monument (town water)	Town of Monument	Odd/even, 3 days a week, no Sunday. **Extended for 2026 only: 7 April – 30 October** (normally 15 May – 30 Sept).
Monument / Gleneagle	Woodmoor W&SD	Odd/even 3 days a week, no Monday, nothing 10am–6pm. Programme ran **1 June – 30 September**, so it has just lapsed for the season. **No drought stage declared.**
Castle Rock	Castle Rock Water	Went **Stage 2 mandatory in July**, back to **Stage 1 on 1 September**. Every third day, before 8am / after 8pm.
Larkspur, Sedalia, Franktown, Divide, Florissant, rural Monument / Black Forest	**Mostly private wells**	No municipal restriction — **and possibly no legal lawn watering at all.** See the next section.

Denver's total ban does not apply to us. Denver Water banned all lawn watering and spray irrigation from 1 October, with $500 and $1,000 fines, and it runs until the board lifts it — possibly through spring 2027. **No property we work is on Denver Water.** It matters only because customers read the news and will ask, and because it shows where the region is heading.

The one most people get wrong: wells

⚑ A WELL IS NOT A LOOPHOLE

Most private wells on parcels **under 35 acres** permitted since **8 May 1972** are **household-use-only**. That means water for inside the house. **It cannot legally be used to irrigate a lawn or garden at all** — not two days a week, not at night, not ever. This is a condition of the well permit and has nothing to do with drought.

Parcels of **35 acres or more** may carry full exempt-well uses, which can include **up to one acre of lawn and garden**.

What this means at the door: on a rural property, *"I'm on a well so restrictions don't apply to me"* may be exactly backwards. **Ask what the well permit allows before quoting an overseed.** If the answer is household-use-only, the seed has no legal water, and we should be selling aeration, mowing or cleanup instead.

The permit is the owner's and so is the responsibility. But quoting an overseed to someone who cannot legally water it is a job that fails and a customer who is unhappy.

The closing tool nobody else is using

Colorado Springs Utilities issues establishment permits, and most lawn outfits never mention them. It is the single most useful thing in this document for selling an overseed in the Springs.

- Allows watering **more often than three days a week, and during normally banned daytime hours**
- **42 days for seeding projects** (28 days for sod, flowers, shrubs, trees)

- Only needed for **sprinklers**. Drip, watering cans and hose-end with a shut-off nozzle are allowed any time regardless
- Apply online, or in person at the Conservation and Environmental Center, 2855 Mesa Rd
- Customer gets a printable permit and can pick up a yard sign

> ⚑ READ THIS BEFORE PROMISING A CUSTOMER THEY CAN GET ONE
>
> For **sod or non-native grass seed**, they must submit receipts for **either 4 cubic yards per 1,000 sq ft of approved soil amendment, mixed into the soil**, or **a soil test from a professional laboratory**.
>
> On a ¾-acre lawn the amendment option is about **131 cubic yards**. That does not happen on an aeration job. **The soil test is the realistic route**, and it is not something we currently include or price.
>
> **For native grass there is no soil prep requirement at all** — just a receipt showing the mix, which has to be on the utility's qualifying list. **That makes seed choice a business decision, not just an agronomy one.** A qualifying native mix turns the permit into a receipt. A non-native mix turns it into a soil test the customer has to go and buy.

Can Sixfold get the permit itself?

Almost certainly not in our own name. The utility's wording is *"any residential or commercial water customer."* At a customer's house the water customer is the customer — we have no account at that address and nothing to attach a permit to. **The permit belongs to the property, not to the contractor.**

What we can realistically do is **apply on their behalf, or walk them through it** — which is the useful version anyway, because it costs us nothing and it is the part customers do not know about. **Whether the utility formally allows a contractor to file for a customer is not confirmed.** The state landscape trade association publishes a contractor-facing video on these permits, which suggests contractors handle them routinely, but the video could not be reviewed and the utility's own document says nothing either way.

One call settles it: ESTP@csu.org, or the Conservation and Environmental Center, 2855 Mesa Rd.

Does it cost money?

No fee appears anywhere in the utility's own document. Both published copies of the establishment permit PDF were fetched and they are byte-identical — neither mentions a fee, a charge, or a cost.

A secondary site said **$50**. That figure is **not corroborated by the utility** and should not be repeated to a customer. Ask on the same phone call.

⚑ It is not a licence, and it is not per county

Three things that are easy to run together, and are not the same:

THING	WHAT IT IS	SCOPE
Establishment permit / irrigation exemption	A temporary watering allowance for **one property** while new planting takes	**Per water provider**, tied to a service address
Contractor registration	A provider or town signing off on who may do the work	Per jurisdiction, where it exists at all

THING	WHAT IT IS	SCOPE
Trade licence	e.g. the Colorado Springs tree licence for trees 15 ft and over	Per jurisdiction. Separate question, already tracked

The unit is the water provider, not the county. El Paso County alone contains Colorado Springs Utilities, Town of Monument, Woodmoor, Donala, Triview and Palmer Lake — six providers, six sets of rules, in one county. **A permit from one is worth nothing at an address served by another.**

PROVIDER	SCHEME	TERMS
Colorado Springs Utilities	Establishment permit	**42 days for seed**, 28 for sod. Lifts the three-day limit and the daytime ban. Soil test or amendment receipts for non-native seed
Castle Rock Water	**Temporary Irrigation Exemption**	**30 consecutive days for seed**, 21 for new turf. Water any day — **but the time-of-day rule still applies** (before 8am / after 8pm). ⚑ **Not available during July**
Woodland Park, Town of Monument, Woodmoor, Donala, Triview, Palmer Lake	**Unknown**	**Not checked. Do not assume a scheme exists**

Castle Rock also runs a "Registered Landscape Professional" programme, and its resource page carries the exemption forms — the closest thing in our territory to the licence-per-area question. **Whether registration is required or voluntary, what it costs, and whether it lets a contractor file exemptions for a client are all unconfirmed.** Castle Rock Water conservation team, **720-733-2306**.

What to say, and what not to

SAY	DO NOT SAY
"Aeration still works on your watering days: water the day before and soon after." True on a green lawn everywhere in our territory.	Anything that sounds like a promise the seed will come up. We do not water and do not guarantee germination — that is in the agreement, and it needs to match what we say at the door.
"Which water provider are you on?" Ask it on every lawn walk. One line, and it changes what we should sell.	A specific watering schedule for a provider without checking it that week.
"If you're on Colorado Springs Utilities there's a permit that lets you water more often while new seed comes in. I can tell you how to get it."	*"You're on a well so the restrictions don't apply."* Often the opposite.
"Water the lawn a day or two before we come out." Now written into the agreements.	A price for the establishment permit. We have not confirmed there is one.

What is not settled

Named here rather than quietly filled in.

1. **Colorado Springs' current stage was last confirmed in May.** Utilities entered Water Shortage Preparation in March and the Gazette reported in April that they were emphasising caution rather than new restrictions. **Denver escalated hard in late August and no September source for Colorado Springs could be found.** The three-day figure is what our quotes and ads depend on. **One phone call settles it.**
2. **Donala, Triview and Palmer Lake were not pinned down.** All three serve parts of Monument and Gleneagle. Donala draws from the depleting Denver Basin aquifer, which is the profile most likely to restrict.

3. **Three things about permits, all answerable in two phone calls.** (a) Whether Colorado Springs lets a contractor file on a customer's behalf — **ESTP@csu.org**. (b) Whether there is a fee at all; a secondary source said $50 and **both copies of the utility's own PDF are silent**, so do not quote a price. (c) Whether Castle Rock's Registered Landscape Professional programme is required of us to work there, and what it costs — **720-733-2306**.
4. **Whether the other six providers have an establishment scheme at all.** Woodland Park, Town of Monument, Woodmoor, Donala, Triview and Palmer Lake were not checked. **Do not assume.**
5. **Whether mid-October is too late to seed at all.** Cool-season overseeding is normally a late-summer job. If it is past the window, that is a bigger problem than the watering rules, and **dormant seeding** — seed down late, germinates in spring — may be the honest version. Not researched.
6. **What to sell on a household-use-only well where the lawn is brown.** CSU says don't aerate a dormant lawn; this document still says “sell aeration, mowing or cleanup” there. A sales decision for Brandon.
7. **Our live Meta ad says nothing about water.** “Fall Aeration 2026” is running at $50/day and is aeration-led, which is the safe half. Worth a read-through now that this is known.

Fact-check log

`TIER A` first-party source, read directly. `TIER B` named outlet. `TIER C` inferred or secondary — treat as unconfirmed.

CLAIM	TIER	SOURCE AND DATE
Denver Water banned all lawn watering and spray irrigation from 1 Oct 2026; runs until the board lifts it	A	denverwater.org, board decision reported 26 Aug 2026
Denver fines $500 / $1,000 residential, $1,000 / $2,000 commercial	B	Denverite, 29 Sept 2026
Colorado Springs: 3 days/week, before 10am / after 6pm May 1 – Oct 15	A	csu.org Water Wise Rules
Colorado Springs entered “Water Shortage Preparation” 18 March 2026, rules unchanged	A	csu.org Water Shortage Preparation
Colorado Springs fines start at $100	B	KOAA
Colorado Springs is **not** on mandatory two-day odd/even restrictions	A	csu.org, corroborated by CPR 14 Apr 2026. **Two SEO sites asserted the opposite** — see the note below
Establishment permit: 42 days for seed, 28 for sod; sprinklers only; soil amendment 4 yd^3/1,000 sq ft **or** a professional soil test; native grass exempt from soil prep	A	csu.org EstablishmentPermit.pdf, read in full
Establishment permit costs $50	C	Secondary source only. **Both published copies of the utility's PDF were fetched, are byte-identical, and mention no fee. Do not quote it**
The permit attaches to the water customer, not the contractor	A	csu.org EstablishmentPermit.pdf — *“any residential or commercial water customer”*
Whether a contractor may file on a customer's behalf	–	**Not confirmed.** The utility's document is silent. A trade-association video aimed at contractors exists but could not be reviewed
Castle Rock Temporary Irrigation Exemption: 30 days seed, 21 days turf, any day, time-of-day still applies, **not available in July**	A	crconserve.com / crgov.com
Castle Rock runs a Registered Landscape Professional programme whose resource page carries the exemption forms	A	crgov.com. **Whether it is required, what it costs and what it permits are unconfirmed**

CLAIM	TIER	SOURCE AND DATE
Woodland Park at Level 2, two days a week by address, no watering noon–6pm May–Sept	A	woodlandpark.gov
Town of Monument: odd/even, no Sunday, extended 7 Apr – 30 Oct for 2026 only	A	townofmonument.org newsflash
Woodmoor: odd/even, no Monday, 1 June – 30 Sept, no drought stage declared	A	woodmoorwater.com; Q3 newsletter asks only that customers “be mindful”
Castle Rock: Stage 2 in July, back to Stage 1 on 1 September	B	Colorado Politics 22 July 2026; Castle Rock drought management page
Water thoroughly the day before aerating; water soon after; regular watering should follow; don't core-aerate a lawn brown or dormant from water restrictions	A	Colorado State University Extension, PlantTalk 1505 and 1534, read 4 Oct 2026
~~Aeration does not need water~~ — wrong, corrected 4 Oct 2026	–	Never sourced; replaced by the CSU row above
Wells under 35 acres permitted since 8 May 1972 are commonly household-use-only and **may not irrigate a lawn**	A	Colorado DWR, *Guideline 2023-1, Uses of Water From Exempt and Small Capacity Wells*
35+ acre parcels may irrigate up to one acre of lawn and garden	A	Same guideline, citing C.R.S. 37-92-602(3)(b)(II)(A)
Colorado Springs adjusted expected water yield to 41% of average, lowest on record; ~3 years in storage	B	KKTV / Axios, spring 2026
Donala, Triview, Palmer Lake current status	–	**Not checked.** Listed as an open item
Whether mid-October is too late to overseed	–	**Not researched.** Listed as an open item

⚑ A SOURCING NOTE WORTH KEEPING

Two sites — `water-restrictions.com` and `lawnbyseason.com` — confidently asserted that Colorado Springs is under “Stage 1 Mandatory, twice per week, odd Monday/Wednesday, even Tuesday/Thursday.” **That is Denver and Aurora's rule, misattributed to Colorado Springs.** Both were blocked and the figures re-taken from csu.org and CPR.

This is the same failure that set the research standard in the house rules: content farms recycling confident, wrong specifics. **If a watering schedule cannot be found on the provider's own site, it does not go in a quote.**

Sources

- Denver Water — https://www.denverwater.org/tap/drought-conditions-worsen-denver-board-water-commissioners-declares-formal-end-lawn-watering
- Colorado Springs Utilities, Water Wise Rules — https://www.csu.org/water-wise-rules/
- Colorado Springs Utilities, Establishment Permits — https://www.csu.org/hubfs/Document%20Library/EstablishmentPermit.pdf
- Colorado Springs Utilities, Water Shortage Preparation — https://www.csu.org/water-service/sustainable-water-plan/water-shortage-preparation
- Town of Monument — https://www.townofmonument.org/m/newsflash/home/detail/359

- Woodmoor W&SD — https://www.woodmoorwater.com/mandatory-water-use-program
- Woodland Park — https://woodlandpark.gov/190/Water-Restrictions-Conservation
- Castle Rock Water, drought management — https://www.crgov.com/2979/Drought-Management
- Castle Rock Water, temporary irrigation exemption — https://crconserve.com/196/Guidelines
- Castle Rock, Registered Landscape Professional resources — https://www.crgov.com/3904/Registered-Landscape-Professional-Resour
- Colorado DWR, well permitting — https://dwr.colorado.gov/services/well-permitting
- Colorado DWR, Guideline 2023-1 — https://dnrweblink.state.co.us/dwr/ElectronicFile.aspx?docid=4187690&dbid=0
- CPR, restrictions roundup — https://www.cpr.org/2026/04/14/colorado-water-restrictions-drought/
- Colorado Politics, Castle Rock Stage 2 — https://www.coloradopolitics.com/2026/07/22/castle-rock-implements-mandatory-stage-2-water-restrictions/

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Internal reference. Researched 2026-09-30. Not legal advice and not customer-facing. Drought stages change — check the provider before quoting.